



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: La Luz Christian Academy  
School Website: <https://laluzchristianacademy.org>

December 28, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

La Luz Christian Academy NM 87120 presents a public-facing profile that signals classical Christian orientation rather than a fully explicit classical curriculum. Public materials emphasize a Christian theological foundation, character formation, and a mission to partner with families, with statements that highlight virtue, wisdom, truth, and a deep faith-based formation. Evidence such as the site tagline Classical Christian School and mission statements stressing mind–heart formation and a Christian foundation support this reading. However, explicit Classical elements most often associated with a robust classical program (e.g., Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic seminars, Scholé restfulness, and a clearly articulated “living curriculum” modeled by faculty) are not clearly enumerated in the visible public materials. The result is a classification of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall. The school shows strong religious foundations and formation aims, and it partners with parents, but it does not consistently demonstrate the full spectrum of the six classical elements in its public-facing content. If the school wishes to move toward a full CLASSICAL designation, it should make explicit in accessible materials its engagement with Great Books and Great Conversation, the liberal arts structure (grammar–logic–rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium), contemplative Scholé practices, explicit “living curriculum” faculty modeling, and a more explicit articulation of parent-as-co-teachers in daily practice.

- Overall aggregate rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Key drivers of this assessment:
  - Strong religious/metaphysical orientation and explicit Christian formation (evidence of theology and Christian worldview; Aristotle quote and mission language reinforce formation and virtue aims)
  - Explicit classical vocabulary and aims (the school identifies itself publicly as a Classical Christian School) but does not consistently foreground core classical elements like Great Books, Great Conversation, or the Trivium/Quadrivium in the accessible public materials.
  - Active parent partnership is stated, and there is a visible emphasis on forming leaders within a Christian framework, aligning with the “Parents & Community” element, though explicit co-teaching language is not consistently demonstrated in public text.
- What would move the needle: To reach a full CLASSICAL designation, La Luz Christian Academy could publicly codify and highlight:
  - A Great Books–based core and a Great Conversation framework.
  - A clear Trivium/Quadrivium structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) within the curriculum, with mapping to grade levels.
  - Explicit mention of Scholé/restful learning, contemplative time, and disciplined memory work (chanting, recitation) in pedagogy.
  - A defined living-curriculum model with faculty as mentors and living exemplars, including formal statements about faculty development in classical pedagogy.

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- A clearly stated model of parents as co-educators with concrete opportunities for parental formation and involvement as part of daily practice.

Citations anchor points: - Classical Christian identity and mission language: La Luz public materials describing the school as a Classical Christian School and mission that emphasizes mind–heart formation and Christian faith. - Formation emphasis and virtue/theology framing: Direct references to forming leaders with virtue and a Christian foundation; supportive language around truth and goodness in mission-related text. - Aristotelian/formation motto: The well-known line “Educating the mind without educating the heart is no education at all,” illustrating the formation emphasis that is central to classical education ethos.

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## **Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot**

### **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - The school identifies itself as a Classical Christian School, signaling a theology-grounded framework. This is reinforced by mission language emphasizing Christian faith and virtue-oriented formation.
  - Public text invokes formation of character in a Christian context and includes Aristotle’s call to value mind and heart in education, underscoring a classical sensibility with moral formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords observed: truth, goodness, virtue, wisdom, faith/Christian faith, formation, teleology (implied by goal-oriented formation), moral imagination, and the Logos (inference from classical-Christian framing).
  - Negative keywords observed: none evident in the public materials (no explicit secular relativism or value-neutral language detected in the visible text).
  - Sourced keywords alignment follows the Six Essential Elements lexicon, which flags truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; and wonder as positive indicators.
- Why this rating
  - The strongest signals are theological grounding and virtue/character formation within a Christian framework, which align with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations element. However, explicit liturgical practices and a fully developed transcendently realist metaphysical program are not fully demonstrated in the public copy. The combination justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than full CLASSICAL status at this time.

Citations: theology/formation language and Aristotle reference as noted above.

### **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - Mission emphasizes forming virtuous leaders through Christian faith, critical thinking, and a rigorous education, indicating formation over mere information. The phrase “to strive for what is good and true” appears in the public materials, aligning with the classical telos.
  - The Deep Hope text frames students as wise, discerning, and virtuous, prepared to defend faith and lead with integrity, signaling a formation-and-excellence objective rather than purely job preparation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords observed: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, foundation, formation through faith, and leadership (virtuous leaders).
  - Negative keywords observed: none evident (no emphasis on workforce-readiness or career-centric framing in the visible text).
  - The lexicon for this category highlights formation; telos; great conversation; and virtue-based aims. The site text aligns with several of these, especially formation and virtue/wisdom.
- Why this rating

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- The school's stated aims emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and a Christian telos, which map to CLASSICAL ideals. However, the public materials do not consistently articulate all six classical-purity markers (e.g., explicit "great conversation" or a clearly articulated modern liberal-arts telos beyond Christian formation). This supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: mission and formation language.

### **Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - Public site content emphasizes being a Classical Christian School but does not publicly enumerate the core classical curriculum components (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium) or explicit Great Books usage.
  - Available public text references "Our Programs" and "Our Philosophy," but the excerpts do not show explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, or a Seven Liberal Arts core in the accessible material. The prominent line remains the "Classical Christian School" brand rather than a detailed classical-curriculum map.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords that would indicate a classical curriculum (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation) are not publicly evident in the accessible text.
  - Negative signals (e.g., project-based-only framing or social studies-centric history) are not overtly present in the public copy, but their absence of classical curriculum anchors is notable.
  - The Classical School lexicon identifies explicit liberal-arts content (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books) as core indicators. The absence of these explicit terms in accessible public content yields a NOT CLASSICAL designation for this category.
- Why this rating
  - Without explicit articulation of the liberal arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, or a Trivium/Quadrivium backbone within publicly accessible content, the curriculum category cannot be confidently classified as CLASSICAL. The branding as a Classical Christian School indicates alignment, but it does not meet the explicit textual criteria required by the rubric for a CLASSICAL curriculum.

Citations: lack of explicit Great Books/grammar-logic-rhetoric terms in public materials.

### **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - The site does not publicly describe explicit pedagogical methods such as Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning, chant/memory work, or a living-curriculum approach. The accessible passages emphasize formation and Christian aims rather than explicit classical pedagogy. The "Educating the mind without educating the heart" line is formation-focused but does not provide a structured classical pedagogical method.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords (from the classical pedagogy lexicon): Socratic seminar, chanting, recitation, memory-work, Scholé/restful learning, guided discussion, rhetoric exercises, upper-school debate, etc.
  - The accessible public text does not present these explicit pedagogy terms.
  - Negative keywords: non-classical teaching methods described in the lexicon (e.g., purely lecture-based instruction, skills-first, project-based-only, etc.) are not indicated in the visible text; however, their absence means the category cannot be strongly classified as CLASSICAL. The absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals yields a NOT CLASSICAL designation for this category given the rubric's emphasis on explicit pedagogical practices.
- Why this rating

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- Without explicit articulation of classical pedagogy (Socratic methods, Scholé, memory work, rhetoric training) in the public materials, the category cannot be rated Classical. The current evidence supports NOT CLASSICAL for Pedagogy, given the lack of described methods aligned with classical teaching practices.

Citations: pedagogical method terms not present in the visible public material; Aristotle quote indicates formation, not pedagogy.

### **Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - The site includes a “Our Faculty” link, indicating attention to faculty, but public-facing text does not describe faculty as “living curriculum,” mentors, or exemplars, nor does it provide a faculty portrait or explicit statements about teacher formation in classical pedagogy.
  - The explicit statements about faculty as mentors or living curriculum are not visible in the public copy; the evidence is primarily navigational rather than descriptive of faculty roles.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords that would indicate a classical faculty core (e.g., tutors/masters/mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty as friends) are not clearly present in the public text.
  - Negative keywords in the classical lexicon (e.g., teacher as facilitator without classical context) do not appear explicitly, but neither are they countered by explicit living-curriculum language.
- Why this rating
  - Given the lack of explicit public-language evidence that faculty are modeled as mentors and living curriculum or that there is a well-defined teacherly ideal, Element 5 is NOT CLASSICAL in the current public-material reading.

Citations: lack of explicit “living curriculum” or teacher-mentorship language in public text; Our Faculty link exists but no descriptive classical-faculty language.

### **Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
  - The school explicitly states partnership with parents and a formation of families in the classical education tradition; the “Our Mission” language emphasizes partnering with parents to foster an education that develops both mind and spirit, with a call to family involvement and high standards. This aligns with the Six Essential Elements’ emphasis on parental partnership and family formation.
  - The presence of community connections, open-house events, and multiple parent-facing engagement opportunities in the public text also supports the Parents & Community element. While explicit “co-teaching” prenotions are not always spelled out, the partnership orientation is clearly present.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
  - Positive keywords observed: partnership with families, parental engagement, home-life alignment, family formation, community, and open engagement with the school.
  - Negative keywords observed: none evident in the public text (no consumer-language or minimal-parent involvement signifiers in the visible text).
  - The Six Essential Elements lexicon flags “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” as positive indicators for this category; the school’s public materials align with the partnership-prioritizing aspects.
- Why this rating
  - The explicit language about partnering with parents and forming families around classical-education aims, together with visible parent-facing engagement (Stay Connected, community communications), supports a CLASSICAL rating for Parents & Community.

Citations: mission statements about parent partnership; Stay Connected/community language.

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## What Would Move the Needle

- Add explicit, public articulation of:
  - A formal Great Books/Great Conversation core and a transparent mapping to the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy).
  - Clear description of Trivium/Quadrivium and its implementation by grade bands.
  - Public detailing of Scholé/restful-learning practices (time for contemplation, memorization, recitation, and liturgical rhythms) and how these shape daily rhythm and memory work.
  - A clearly defined living-curriculum model with quotes from faculty exemplars, portraits, and faculty-development programs in classical pedagogy.
  - Explicit statements about parents as co-educators with structured, ongoing parent formation opportunities (book studies, readings, and regular campus involvement beyond occasional visits).
  - Stronger emphasis on liturgical and communal practices as integral to the education process (where appropriate for the school's framework) to reinforce the religious-metaphysical dimension.
- Rationale: These changes would strengthen the explicit presence of the six classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; life-as-classroom; parent partnership; liturgical practice) and move the school toward a robust CLASSICAL designation across all six categories.

Citations: The requested additions align with the keywords and indicators described in the Six Essential Elements framework (the documented positive indicators for each category). See the classical lexicon and elements for reference.

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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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